

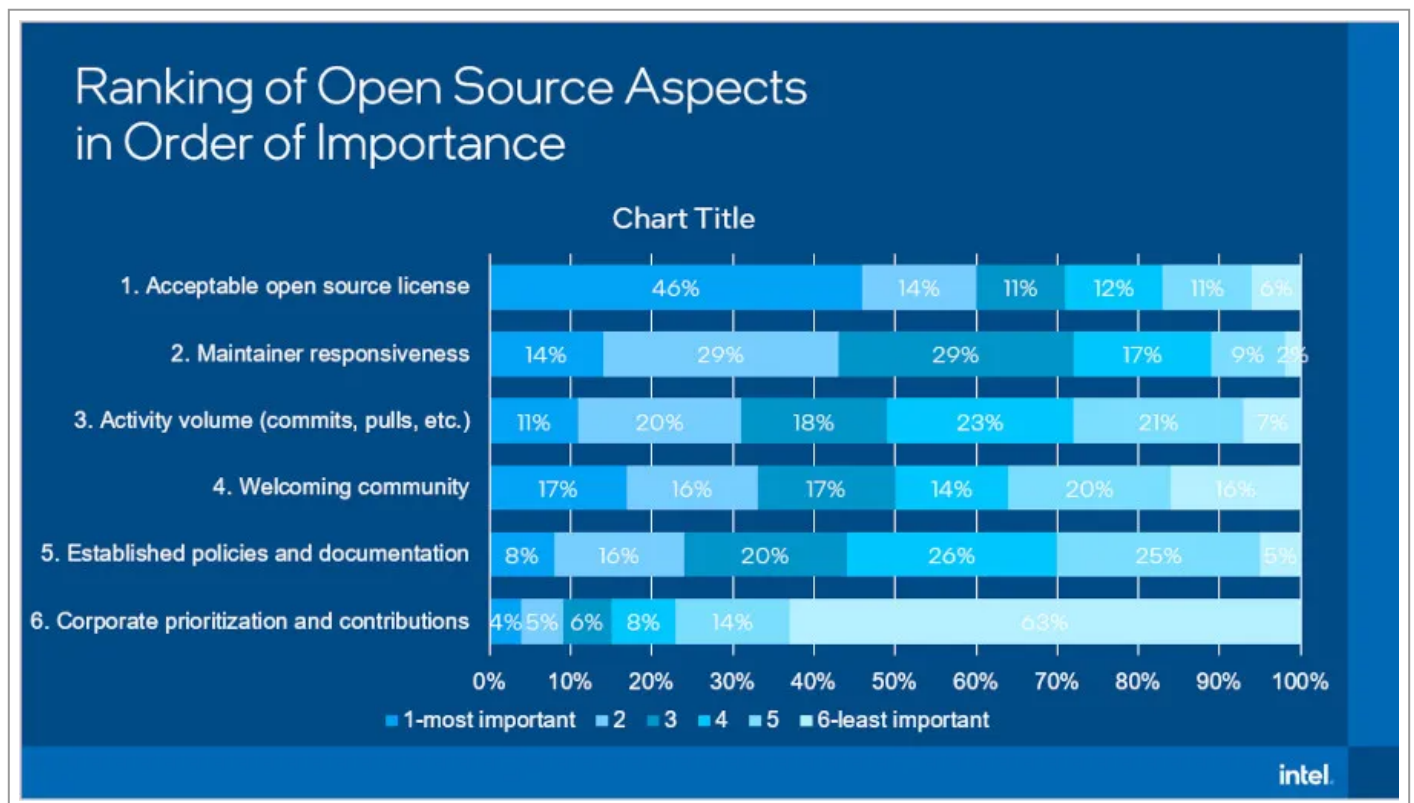
Intel Survey Finds Maintainer Burnout & Documentation Top Open-Source Challenges

Written by [Michael Larabel](#) in [Intel](#) on 20 February 2024 at 02:35 PM EST. [22 Comments](#)



At the end of last year Intel hosted [a survey of open-source developers](#) to collect their feedback on various open-source software issues. Intel's 2023 Open Source Community Survey is all wrapped up, the data tallied up, and the results emailed out today to participants.

I haven't seen Intel post this data on any public web page yet, but per the email, below are all of the results collected from their open-source survey for 2023.



To hardly any surprise, the survey found having an acceptable open-source license was the most important open-source aspect. The license was followed by maintainer responsiveness, activity volume, welcoming community, and then the established policies and documentation.

Top Open Source Challenges Faced

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Maintainer burnout	45%
Documentation and onboarding	41%
Maintaining sustainability	37%
Building community engagement	32%
Insufficient budgets and program costs	31%
Technical debt (contributors do not finish and organizers need to evolve it)	30%
Quality assurance	27%
Security and vulnerability management	23%
Compatibility and interoperability	22%
Licensing and compliance	16%
Legal and intellectual property issues	14%
Lack of training opportunities	14%
Other	8%
None of the above	3%

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Of those participating in the survey, Intel found the top open-source challenge faced was maintainer burnout at 45%... That was followed by documentation/onboarding at 41% and then maintaining sustainability at 37%.

Open Source Projects of Greatest Interest

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Linux	80%
Rust	42%
Clang/LLVM	38%
GCC	35%
Kubernetes	24%
Pytorch	17%
eBPF	15%
oneAPI	12%
TensorFlow	12%
OpenJDK	10%
MySQL	8%
Kafka	6%
Spark	5%
Envoy	3%
Other	32%

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Another result of little surprise was finding the open-source project of greatest interest being Linux itself. That was followed by Rust, Clang/LLVM, GCC, and then Kubernetes.

Importance of Open Source in AI

82%

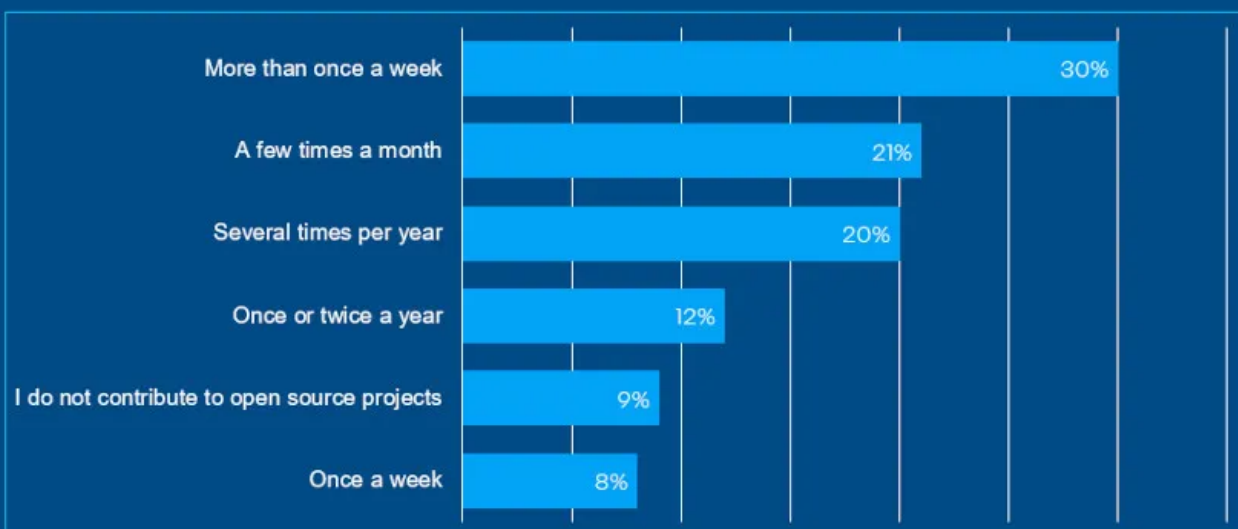
Extremely + Very Important

Importance of Open Source in AI	
Extremely important for innovation	66%
Very important but not essential	16%
Neutral	12%
Not overly important but helpful	3%
Not at all Important	3%

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And as a sign of the times, of course AI was brought up in the survey.... And 82% found open-source in AI being either extremely or very important.

Frequency of Contribution to Open Source Projects



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Of those that participated in this Intel open-source survey, 30% of those contributed to open-source projects more than once per week.

22 Comments

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Michael Larabel is the principal author of Phoronix.com and founded the site in 2004 with a focus on enriching the Linux hardware experience. Michael has written more than 20,000 articles covering the state of Linux hardware support, Linux performance, graphics drivers, and other topics. Michael is also the lead developer of the Phoronix Test Suite, Phoromatic, and OpenBenchmarking.org automated benchmarking software. He can be followed via [Twitter](#), [LinkedIn](#), or contacted via [MichaelLarabel.com](#).

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